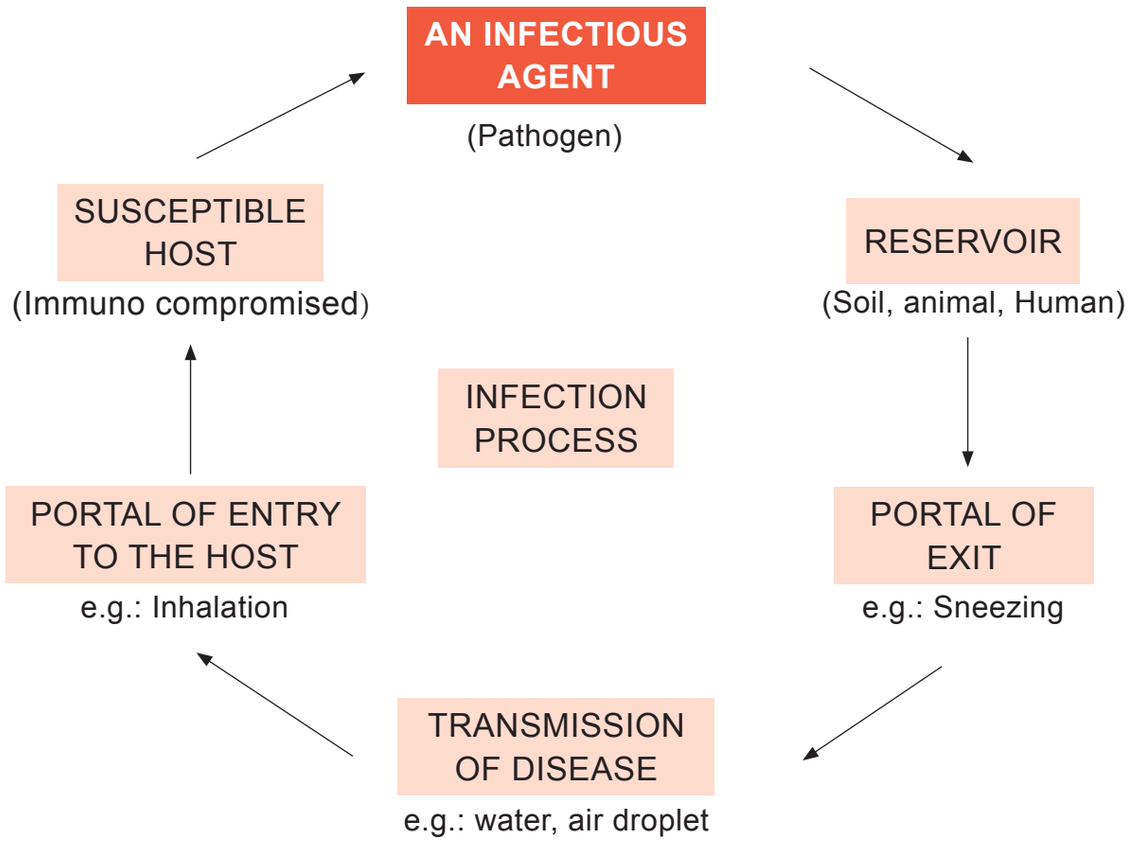




When you cough germs can travel about 3 metres. If you do not put your hand or hand kerchief.

6.5.1 Chains of infection:

i) Infectious Agent: -

Microorganisms include bacteria, viruses, fungi and protozoa. They are common infectious agents or pathogens. The potential for microorganisms to cause disease is depends on the following factors.

- Sufficient number of pathogens (Inoculum) which enter into the body.
- Virulence or ability to produce disease.
- Ability to enter and survive in the host (overcome the immune system of the host).
- Susceptibility of host.

ii) Reservoir: - A reservoir is where a pathogen can survive.

- A continual source of infection is called a reservoir infection.
- People who have a disease are carriers of pathogenic organisms (**human reservoir**).
- Zoonoses can be transmitted to humans from animal reservoirs of infection.
- Some pathogenic microorganisms grow in nonliving reservoirs Ex-Soil, Water.

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